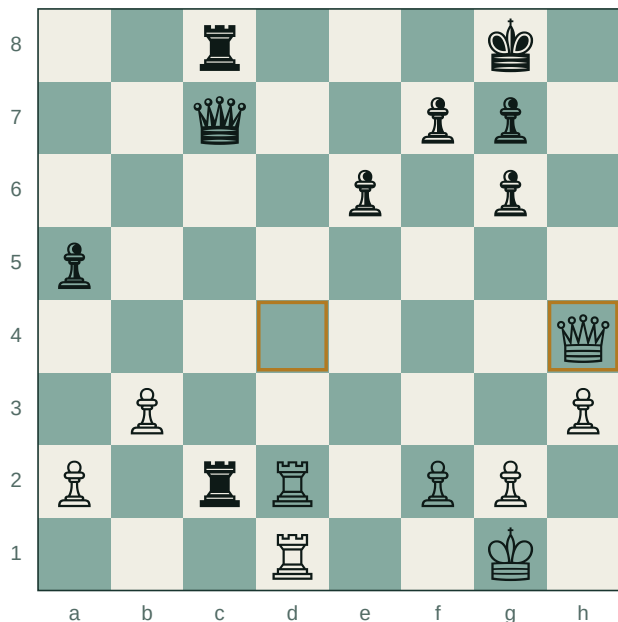


Clearance tactics: Black, move 26

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 26.Qh4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26...Rxd2 27. Rxd2 Qc1+ 28. Rd1 Qxd1+

26...Rxd2 The rook captures the rook on d2. Recorded reply: **27.Rxd2**.

27...Qc1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From c1 it attacks king on g1 and rook on d2. Recorded reply: **28.Rd1**.

28...Qxd1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on d1.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from +0 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on h4. Check for tactical protection.